



SINCERE MILK CHILDREN

DEVOTIONAL GUIDE

JULY
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Abraham Goes To Egypt

KEY VERSE

"And there was a famine in the land: and Abram went down into Egypt to sojourn there; for the famine was grievous in the land."
(Genesis 12:10)

BIBLE TEXT

Genesis 12:10-20



Bible history clearly shows us that Egypt was an idolatrous place. The leadership and citizens were not friendly. This equally applies to our present time, where some rulers oppress the poor; children and adults. Abraham was a friend God but fear and famine made him to go down to Egypt to look for greener pasture. As a result of the search for a better life, he told a lie. This almost led to adultery and loss of his wife.

As friends of Jesus, while you desire the good things of life; you must beware of the evil things in the world. Avoid bad company. Keep off from people, events or things that will take you to the Egypt of today. Don't look back from following the path of holiness and the truth of God's word.

God in His mercy preserved Abraham and Sarah and they inherited their covenant blessings. God does not take delight in your downfall, seek Him while He is near. If you have backslidden or you are lost in sin, confess your sins and call on Jesus to wash you with His blood. He will surely show you mercy.



PRAYER:

Dear Lord, help me not to go back to my sinful ways.

FURTHER READING:

Genesis 26:1-6





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The Moving Vehicle

KEY VERSE

"These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, & embraced them..." Hebrews 11:13

BIBLE TEXT

Hebrews 11:9-16



One day, Joy's dad went to pick her and her brother from school. On their way to the house, the car suddenly stopped moving. The engine refused to start and had to be pushed off the road.

The above car is just like every living soul (boy/girl) on earth. Often times, some cars will suddenly stop working and it is an indication that it needs to be repaired. Usually, cars should be maintained through constant servicing. You must check the water level, engine oil level, tyres etc., on a daily basis. Don't forget that every car is being driven by a driver. Who is the driver of your life?

Friends of Jesus are strangers and pilgrims on earth. Jesus is the Driver of their lives. Sin, compromise, worldly allurements etc., can knock you down if you are careless. Beware! Service your life daily through constant check-up. Read the Bible, pray always and rest in God's grace. All souls are moving vehicles; either to heaven or hell.

Decide who drives the car of your life now. Connect to Jesus as you seek for cleansing through His shed blood. He will forgive and guide you steadily to heaven at last.



PRAYER:

Heavenly Father, drive me safely through the journey of life.

FURTHER READING:

Genesis 47:9





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The Treasure House

KEY VERSE

"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life."
Proverbs 4:23

BIBLE TEXT

Proverbs 4:20-24



A gate is an opening used to allow or disallow entry into or out of an enclosed place. Through the gate, good things get in and bad things are prevented from coming in. Dave dashed out of the house to join other members of the family in the car going for vacation. He forgot to close the gate and the door to the house. The thieves entered their house and stole valuable items before they returned.

Our eyes, ears, mouth, hands are like gates to our heart which is a treasure house that controls the issues of life. The things we do with them have effect on our heart. We receive grace to overcome when we listen to, read and think on God's word. But such grace gets lost when dirty things get into the heart. Watching bad contents on phones/TV corrupt. Reading bad books and magazines pollutes the heart. Listening to dirty songs corrupt your mind. For you to live a life that pleases God and prepare for the rapture, guard your heart. Keep the "gates" closed so that the treasure in it will remain pure and holy.



PRAYER:

Dear Lord, please help me to always 'say no' to all forms of evil from coming into my heart.

FURTHER READING:

Psalms 119:9-11





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Avoidable Regret

KEY VERSE

"For godly sorrow worketh repentance to salvation not to be repented of: but the sorrow of the world worketh death." 2 Corinthians 7:10

BIBLE TEXT

2Corinthians 7:8-12



Margaret with a tone of regret told her friend and said "if only I had done what I knew was right. If only I had listened to my parents..." continuing, she said "I wish I could go back and change some decision I took". She thought about the sinful actions and choices she had made. She regretted not following the advice of her godly parents and living by God's word. Regret is a feeling of sadness about a wrong action or about a mistake made. It is a wish that things could have been different and better. Nobody loves the feeling of regret which many times is avoidable. Regret can come from missed opportunities. It might also arise from poor performance because of poor preparation. Regrets can arise from the pain of disobedience or from bad choices made.

The most painful regret everyone must avoid is missing heaven. Surrender your heart totally to Jesus Christ. Achan, Judas Iscariot, and Herod probably wish they had made different choices. Avoid eternal pain and regret. Choose to obey God and His word even if you are the only one.



PRAYER:

Dear Lord, please help me to always say no to all forms of evil from coming into my heart.

FURTHER READING:

Ephesians 5:15-17





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Prepare For The Rapture

KEY VERSE

Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord." 1 Thessalonians 4:17

BIBLE TEXT

1Thessalonians 4:13-17



The rapture is the catching away of believers to meet Jesus in the air when the trumpet sounds. It will be a signal of the end of time. Only true friends of Jesus will hear this sound and go to meet Him in the clouds. Those who were friends of Jesus before they died will also hear the sound and rise from their graves to meet Jesus in the cloud.

The marriage supper of the Lamb will take place there. Sinners and backsliders will remain on earth to suffer under the reign of the antichrist for seven (7) years. The torment, torture and agony will be much, it would be unbearable. You must endeavor to escape that terrible time because there will be no time for delay because it is dangerous to do so.

How will you prepare for the rapture? - Know yourself as a sinner. - Repent of your sins, confess them to God. - Ask for forgiveness and cleansing through the blood of Jesus. - Invite Jesus into your life as Saviour and Lord. Begin to live for Christ by reading your Bible and praying every day. Tell others about Jesus. Live every day in holiness so that you will not miss the rapture.

PRAYER:

Lord, help me to live in readiness for the rapture every day.

FURTHER READING:

Acts 1:9-11





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The Apostle's Counsel

KEY VERSE

"Furthermore then we beseech you, brethren, and exhort you by the Lord Jesus, that as ye have received of us how ye ought to walk and to please God... 1Thessalonians 4:1"

BIBLE TEXT

1Thessalonians 4:1-7



Living to please God should be the desire of all friends of Jesus. Apostle Paul lived his life to please God Who called him. He wrote this epistle to the Thessalonian Christians to encourage them to also please God in all they do. We are reading this letter to the Thessalonians today and receiving the same charge or challenge to please God daily in all we do, say and think. No one can live to please God in his or her power.

Only God, by His grace, enables us to do this. This grace is available to as many as would come to Jesus. A boy or girl who is still living in sin, doing bad things like fighting, telling lies, stealing, moving with bad friends and doing other evil things cannot receive this grace. Such a person must first come out of sin by confessing to Jesus, asking for forgiveness and cleansing through His precious blood and inviting Him to be his or her Saviour and Lord. If you are a friend of Jesus, be conscious of how you live so that you will not displease instead of pleasing God. Ask God daily for His grace to help you please Him. This will open doors of blessings to you



PRAYER:

God, help me to live to please You at all time.

FURTHER READING:

2Corinthians 13:11





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Positive Influence

KEY VERSE

"And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not" John 1:5

BIBLE TEXT

John 1:1-5



An important aspect of life is influence. Each one of us has influence over someone in this world. It is obvious that the more you lead, the more opportunities for influence you will have.

Both positive and negative influences have been recorded in the history of mankind. Good people have an effect on others for good and bad people have some influence that turn out bad. Everybody is being influenced by someone or something no matter who you are, nobody is an island. We see it all around us, everyone is contributing something to influence others. The question is not if we will influence others but rather what quality of influence we will generate in the lives of others.

As Christians, we should be positive influences. We should influence others for Christ. Let others see Jesus in you, let them see Him in your attitude, lifestyle, behaviour, from the way you treat others. Someday we will stand before the Lord Jesus and give an account of how we spend our lives. It would be wise to live in such a way that the Lord is able to say, "well done thou good and faithful servant!"



PRAYER:

Lord, help me to be a positive influence to those around me.

FURTHER READING:

Matthew 5:13-16





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Lasting Peace

KEY VERSE

"Now the Lord of peace himself
give you peace always by all
means. The Lord be with you
all" - 2 Thessalonians 3:16

BIBLE TEXT

2Thessalonians 3:16-18



The English dictionary defines Peace "as a state free of oppressive, and unpleasant thoughts and emotions". There are different levels of peace. We have ordinary peace, perfect peace and lasting peace. Some levels of peace gives temporary relief from fear and an unpleasant situation. However, the peace that the word of God gives is the perfect and lasting peace. It gives us faith to stand in all weather and overcome all storms and trials. The storm might be much but sometimes; God uses storms to train us so as to be able to develop inner peace. However, we must learn to maintain peace even in the midst of the storm. Jesus slept during the storm and His disciples had to wake Him up (Mark 4:37-38). This is because He had inner peace.

Remember, God is our sufficiency, He is enough to give you lasting peace and calm every storm. You can obtain that peace as you spend your quiet time in His presence today. As a sinner you can enjoy this lasting peace by repenting of your sins and surrendering your life totally unto Christ the Prince of peace.

PRAYER:

Lord, give me lasting peace.

FURTHER READING:

John 14:17





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The Lord Blesses

KEY VERSE

"Then Isaac sowed in that land, and received in the same year an hundredfold: and the LORD blessed him." Genesis 26:12

BIBLE TEXT

Genesis 26:11-14



Isaac was a friend of God. The protection of God was on him. Abimelech warned his people who had been disturbing Isaac to stop their wicked activities towards him. This was God's favour on him. Isaac learned to love the Lord from the time he was a young child. He was that boy who willingly gave himself to his father to be offered as sacrifice to God. God was happy with him and provided a ram from heaven to his father for the burnt offering. The blessing of Abraham passed on to him not just because he was Abraham's son, but because he, personally, loved and obeyed the Lord.

God always blesses those children who love and obey Him. Isaac was not slothful or lazy either. Though he inherited covenant blessings from his father, yet he worked very hard. Our Bible passage confirms that God blessed Isaac more and more. It is not enough to know and quote the promises of God to bless you. If you know all the promises of God in your heart and fold your hand and do not work, the blessings of God's provision may not come. Isaac had all-round blessings.



PRAYER:

Lord, help me to love, obey You and work hard so that You will bless me.

FURTHER READING:

Psalms 1:1-3





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Honoured By God

KEY VERSE

"For I will have respect unto you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, and establish my covenant with you." Leviticus 26:9

BIBLE TEXT

Leviticus 26:9-12



A story was told of a girl called Queen. Queen worked very hard and brought many awards to her family. She was already on Government scholarship in high school. There, she was selected to represent her state in the National Mathematics competition. Queen won the competition to the admiration of everyone including her fellow competitors. The State government raised a podium and set Queen on it for everybody present to file past to salute the Queen.

God has promised to bless and honour His children who are obedient to Him. How can it be that the One we are commanded to respect and honour now promises to honour us - His creatures? There is nothing God cannot do for a child whose life pleases Him. That was His promise to Israel and to anyone that does His will. That honour manifested in God making Israel fruitful, established and secured.

You must do everything to gain the honour, respect, blessing, favour, goodness and mercy of God. Joseph was one child that was respected and honoured. God even caused the king, all Egyptians, the surrounding nations, his father and his brothers to respect and honour him. Your godly and righteous conduct at home, school and in the church will bring divine honour, promotion and respect to you.



PRAYER:

Lord, God give me the grace to live righteously before You so that I may enjoy Your blessings.

FURTHER READING:

Psalms 84:11-12

